



STAGE 1 OF 7

Demand emerges



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too



STAGE 2 OF 7

Work becomes a staffing need



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too



STAGE 3 OF 7

Staffing sees the request



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too



STAGE 4 OF 7

Who could do it, and who is free



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

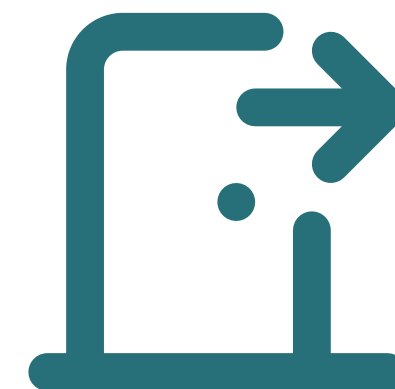
What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too



STAGE 5 OF 7

Can they actually start



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too



STAGE 6 OF 7

Is there a real gap



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too



STAGE 7 OF 7

The gap goes to action



What the record said

Notes: what the system showed

What was really true

Notes: this happens to us too

STAGE 1 · DEMAND EMERGES

The record said

Atlas shows the deal entering contract drafting on 8 September.

Pin face up

STAGE 1 · DEMAND EMERGES

What was really true

The client first raised it in April. Nobody decided whether it was real enough to prepare for.

Lesson: Nobody decides when demand is real enough to start.

STAGE 2 · WORK BECOMES A STAFFING NEED

The record said

The cost case prices six people across four roles, at Bands 6 and 7, by service.

Pin face up

STAGE 2 · WORK BECOMES A STAFFING NEED

What was really true

Nobody turned that into skills. One line says "knowledge transfer as agreed".

Lesson: Sales and staffing describe the same work differently.

STAGE 3 · STAFFING SEES THE REQUEST

The record said

The staffing request was raised three weeks before the start date.

Pin face up

STAGE 3 · STAFFING SEES THE REQUEST

What was really true

Staffing heard about it in a corridor a month earlier, and some work had started outside the tools.

Lesson: The request arrives late, and some staffing happens outside the tools.

STAGE 4 · WHO COULD DO IT, AND WHO IS FREE

The record said

Workday shows the cloud network engineer free from 1 November.

Pin face up

STAGE 4 · WHO COULD DO IT, AND WHO IS FREE

What was really true

Their current project runs to late November. Only their manager knew.

Lesson: Free in the system is not free in reality.

STAGE 5 · CAN THEY ACTUALLY START

The record said

Nothing. Nobody asked.

Pin face up

STAGE 5 · CAN THEY ACTUALLY START

What was really true

**Their manager would have released them
two weeks early, if asked.**

Lesson: Free, releasable and ready to start are three different things.

STAGE 6 · IS THERE A REAL GAP

The record said

The search for a firewall specialist found no match. A gap was recorded and a hire requested.

Pin face up

STAGE 6 · IS THERE A REAL GAP

What was really true

Someone with the skill worked on another account. Nobody asked whether they could move, or whether moves could free someone.

Lesson: No match is not a confirmed gap.

STAGE 7 · THE GAP GOES TO ACTION

The record said

A hiring request and a subcontractor quote at a higher cost. The deal was signed on 29 September.

Pin face up

STAGE 7 · THE GAP GOES TO ACTION

What was really true

The plan was never approved and the gap had no owner. The deal was signed without knowing it could be staffed.

Lesson: A gap needs an owner, and a signature needs an approved plan.

The Northgate deal

ENG-0412 · Northgate · Network and cloud migration · £2.4m · starts 2 November · Liverpool. The Northgate deal and every person in it are invented for this workshop.

A deal from last year, replayed. We replay what happened to Northgate last year, stage by stage. On Day 2 we run the same deal again through the working version, as if it were new.

The four roles

R1	Cloud network engineer Band 7	Workday says P-20931 is free from 1 November. Only their manager knows the current project runs to late November.
R2	Firewall specialist Band 6	The search finds nobody, so a hire is requested. One person with the skill exists, on another account, and nobody asked.
R3	Project manager Band 7	Another deal wants the same project manager in December.
R4	Knowledge-transfer lead To be sized	The contract says "knowledge transfer as agreed". Nobody knows how much.

The seven stages

	STAGE	THE RECORD SAID	WHAT WAS REALLY TRUE
1	Demand emerges	Atlas shows the deal entering contract drafting on 8 September.	The client first raised it in April. Nobody decided whether it was real enough to prepare for.
2	Work becomes a staffing need	The cost case prices six people across four roles, at Bands 6 and 7, by service.	Nobody turned that into skills. One line says "knowledge transfer as agreed".
3	Staffing sees the request	The staffing request was raised three weeks before the start date.	Staffing heard about it in a corridor a month earlier, and some work had started outside the tools.
4	Who could do it, and who is free	Workday shows the cloud network engineer free from 1 November.	Their current project runs to late November. Only their manager knew.
5	Can they actually start	Nothing. Nobody asked.	Their manager would have released them two weeks early, if asked.
6	Is there a real gap	The search for a firewall specialist found no match. A gap was recorded and a hire requested.	Someone with the skill worked on another account. Nobody asked whether they could move, or whether moves could free someone.
7	The gap goes to action	A hiring request and a subcontractor quote at a higher cost. The deal was signed on 29 September.	The plan was never approved and the gap had no owner. The deal was signed without knowing it could be staffed.

Map your own case on the seven stages

Our case, in one line

1 Demand emerges The record said Really Pain 1 to 5	2 Work becomes a staffing need The record said Really Pain 1 to 5	3 Staffing sees the request The record said Really Pain 1 to 5	4 Who could do it, and who is free The record said Really Pain 1 to 5	5 Can they actually start The record said Really Pain 1 to 5	6 Is there a real gap The record said Really Pain 1 to 5	7 The gap goes to action The record said Really Pain 1 to 5
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RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 1 OF 7

Stage 1 · Demand emerges

The record said: Atlas shows the deal entering contract drafting on 8 September.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** The deal appeared in September, the same week it entered drafting, so nobody could have known sooner.
- B.** The client first raised it in April. Nobody decided whether it was real enough to prepare for.
- C.** Sales flagged it in April and staffing began preparing then, but the record was entered late.

RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 2 OF 7

Stage 2 · Work becomes a staffing need

The record said: The cost case prices six people across four roles, at Bands 6 and 7, by service.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** Every skill was listed, but nobody checked them against the contract.
- B.** Staffing turned it into skills at once, but used last year's skills list.
- C.** Nobody turned that into skills. One line says "knowledge transfer as agreed".

RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 3 OF 7

Stage 3 · Staffing sees the request

The record said: The staffing request was raised three weeks before the start date.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** Staffing heard about it in a corridor a month earlier, and some work had started outside the tools.
- B.** The request went to the wrong team first and sat there for a month before staffing saw it.
- C.** Staffing saw it only when the request arrived, and every step after that went through the tools.

RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 4 OF 7

Stage 4 · Who could do it, and who is free

The record said: Workday shows the cloud network engineer free from 1 November.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** They really were free from 1 November, but had booked leave that month.
- B.** Workday was right, but another deal had already reserved them for November.
- C.** Their current project runs to late November. Only their manager knew.

RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 5 OF 7

Stage 5 · Can they actually start

The record said: Nothing. Nobody asked.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** They could have started, but only part-time until the end of November.
- B.** Their manager would have released them two weeks early, if asked.
- C.** Their manager would have refused, because their client wanted to keep them.

RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 6 OF 7

Stage 6 · Is there a real gap

The record said: The search for a firewall specialist found no match. A gap was recorded and a hire requested.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** Someone with the skill worked on another account. Nobody asked whether they could move, or whether moves could free someone.
- B.** Nobody in the firm had the skill, so a hire really was the only way, and the search was right to find no match.
- C.** Two people had the skill, but both were on long leave until the new year, so finding no match was the right answer.

RECORD OR REALITY? · ROUND 7 OF 7

Stage 7 · The gap goes to action

The record said: A hiring request and a subcontractor quote at a higher cost. The deal was signed on 29 September.

What was really true? Hold up A, B or C.

- A.** The plan was approved before signing, but the subcontractor quote came in late and over budget.
- B.** The plan was never approved and the gap had no owner. The deal was signed without knowing it could be staffed.
- C.** The gap had an owner and a date, but the hire took longer than the contract allowed.

Record or reality? Answers

ROUND	ANSWER	LESSON
1	B	Nobody decides when demand is real enough to start.
2	C	Sales and staffing describe the same work differently.
3	A	The request arrives late, and some staffing happens outside the tools.
4	C	Free in the system is not free in reality.
5	B	Free, releasable and ready to start are three different things.
6	A	No match is not a confirmed gap.
7	B	A gap needs an owner, and a signature needs an approved plan.